



COMMON REED
Phragmites australis
F: Poaceae

Widespread in both temperate and tropical regions, this shallow-water grass can colonize large areas via its creeping horizontal stems.

6 m
20 ft



SWEET VERNAL GRASS
Anthoxanthum odoratum
F: Poaceae

Native to Eurasia, this early-flowering grass contains a chemical called coumarin that makes it smell pleasantly of new-mown hay.

1 m
3¼ ft

1.2 m
4 ft

MARRAM GRASS
Calamagrostis arenaria
F: Poaceae

This tough grass from Europe flourishes on sand dunes, which its long underground stems and roots help to stabilize.

1.8 m
6 ft

OAT
Avena sativa
F: Poaceae

This cultivated grass, grown widely as a cereal crop for livestock and human consumption, thrives in cool, wet climates.

awn

80 cm
32 in

BARLEY
Hordeum vulgare
F: Poaceae

Originating in the ancient Near East, this cultivated cereal grass is notable for the long hair-like bristles (awns) on its flowerheads.

1 m
3¼ ft

BREAD WHEAT
Triticum aestivum
F: Poaceae

The world's top-tonnage cereal, this species originated in the ancient Near East. It is a hybrid between the wild and earlier cultivated varieties.



40 cm
16 in

CREEPING BENT-GRASS
Agrostis stolonifera
F: Poaceae

This common perennial grass with feathery flowerheads is found worldwide. It spreads using creeping horizontal stems, or stolons.



3 m
10 ft

CITRONELLA
Cymbopogon nardus
F: Poaceae

A type of lemongrass, citronella originates from tropical Asia. It yields an oil used in perfumes and for repelling insects.

1.8 m
6 ft

RICE
Oryza sativa
F: Poaceae

Native to E. Asia, this major grain crop of warmer regions is usually cultivated in shallow water or in flood-prone areas.



3 m
10 ft

MAIZE
Zea mays
F: Poaceae

This major food crop was first cultivated in ancient Mexico. It has male or female flowerheads – edible corn is the female flower.



6 m
20 ft

SUGAR CANE
Saccharum officinarum
F: Poaceae

Possibly related to maize, this tropical cultivated grass may have originated in New Guinea. Sugar is extracted from its thick stems.



3 m
10 ft

VETIVER
Chrysopogon zizanioides
F: Poaceae

Native to India, this tropical grass is widely cultivated for its fragrant oil and to bind soils to prevent erosion.



90 cm
35 in

PERENNIAL RYE-GRASS
Lolium perenne
F: Poaceae

Much used in pastures, lawns, and sports fields, this common Eurasian grass has now spread around the world.

80 cm
32 in

YORKSHIRE FOG
Holcus lanatus
F: Poaceae

A common European grass found in damp meadows, Yorkshire fog has leaves with soft, velvety hairs.

single stem

dense white
flowerheads

PAMPAS GRASS
Cortaderia selloana
F: Poaceae

This tall grass from southern S. America is a popular ornamental species. It has become invasive in some areas.

3 m
10 ft

